CHAPTER 11

Continuing On

Hopefully, at this point you might have started to think that programming can actually be a lot of fun and you might be looking for new challenges. Naturally, everything that can be done with the Arduino can't be shown in one book, however, in this chapter we will continue on with new project ideas, new hardware, and new programming languages. We will even look at a few ways that you might get involved with the Arduino and open-source communities to share what you've learned and the projects you've made.

Rather than detail complete projects in this chapter, we will look at a few directions to take your learning and experimentation. These topics are loosely related to programming the Arduino—whether it's through compatible hardware or similar ideologies. I will provide you with a general introduction to each of these topics, as well as some resources for learning more, and give you a sense of how these things can interface with the Arduino. This is the bonus round really, just enough to keep you continuing on.

Build More Projects

The first thing to do, of course, with your newfound Arduino skills is build more projects! We couldn't cover every project idea in this one book and I tried to keep what we did talk about to the very basics. So, here are a few things that I would have loved to have previously discussed in more depth that you might be able to try out.

Bonus Project 1: Make Something Tweet

Remember that Arduino Ethernet Shield I suggested was a good idea when we learned how to log data on an SD card? Well, if you have this shield, or maybe one of the new boards called the Arduino Ethernet, then you can make your next project tweet. Maybe you're inspired by the functionality of the Botanicalls shown in Chapter 1, but rather than knowing that your plants need water, you want to know instead when the coffee in the office is ready or the beer keg has been emptied, maybe you really need to keep track of the irregular hours that your cat (or teenager?) enters and leaves the house, or maybe you just want to display an updated status of your whereabouts on a display in your office no matter where you are.